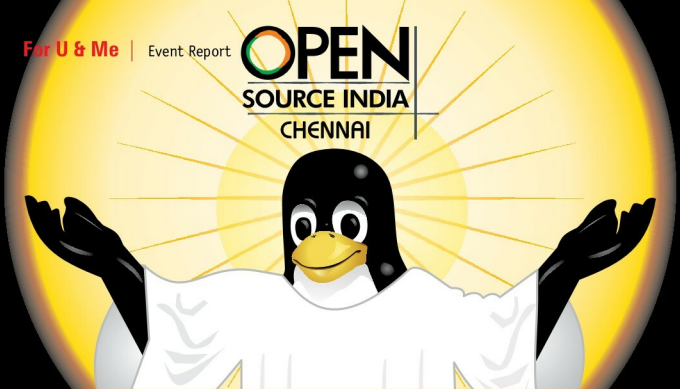




OPEN SOURCE INDIA CHENNAI

Meet the Messiah

March 12-14, 2009. That was Open Source India 2009, Tech Days. Here's a report for those who couldn't be with us at hot, yet happening Chennai.

*"It was the best of times, it was the worst of times..." these words borrowed from Charles Dickens' novel *A Tale of Two Cities* seem apt today. The world is facing an economic slowdown. Businesses are shutting*

down, or at best downsizing. At a time like this, we certainly need a messiah to save us, or at least offer us some relief so that we can continue to survive (and, more importantly, grow). And we found such a saviour in open source.

Today, no company can execute its operations without a significant amount of IT—it's pretty much the backbone for any business. And in hard times like these, maintaining and scaling the IT infrastructure requires investments. However, not many would like to touch the reserves they have. So, what should they do? Open source seems to have the answers.

We did not have this in mind during the initial phases of planning our annual open source business conference. However, once it was clear that we had to address the need of the hour and try to help the industry find some answers, we started looking for experts in the field to share their experiences and *that* shaped the Chennai Chapter of Open Source India 2009—Tech Days.

We realised there were two areas we needed to touch upon. One was the 'soul' of the open source industry—the community and the developers. The second was the enterprise segment, made up of the corporate users. The

Panels, panels and more panels!

Before this edition of Open Source India, we thought handling multiple speakers and tracks was a challenge. But, right on the first day of OSI 2009, we knew that we had taken up an even bigger challenge by planning most of our sessions as panel discussions! We always knew that shifting to a panel discussion format would mean working with many, many more speakers, but what we had not anticipated was the complications that needed to be handled back stage.

Have all speakers reached the venue? Have all of them been introduced to each other? Are they all in sync with the goal of the panel? Phew! Every panel seemed like handling a whole day's content. But, going by the feedback we have received online from many of you—it seems the effort was worth it. Through the panels, we had hoped that the sessions would be more interactive and the interest kept alive amongst the audience—even in the post-lunch sessions! Plus, we hoped that the audience would be able to cross-question the speakers and get a wider and more unbiased perspective. Thankfully, it seems like they did. So, will we have panels in the next edition, too? Most certainly.